

TIMELINE OF DIGITAL MONEY

Since the technology for digital money was perfected, many cryptocurrencies have been released—although Bitcoin remains the largest. Now even central banks have begun investigating the potential of digital money.



Digital currency

Money that can be traded on exchanges directly between individuals using a computer or mobile device that is connected to the internet. Digital currency can also be bought and sold using conventional currencies. See pp.222–225

Crowdfunding

A way for individuals and groups to raise donations from donors via the internet, bypassing banks, charitable organizations, or government institutions. It is managed via an online intermediary who takes a percentage as a fee. See pp.226–227

Peer-to-peer lending

Loans arranged by online marketplaces who match would-be borrowers with lenders. Peer-to-peer lending is usually subject to fewer regulations than with conventional lending. Borrowers are screened for risk, which is reflected in the interest rate they pay. See pp.228–229